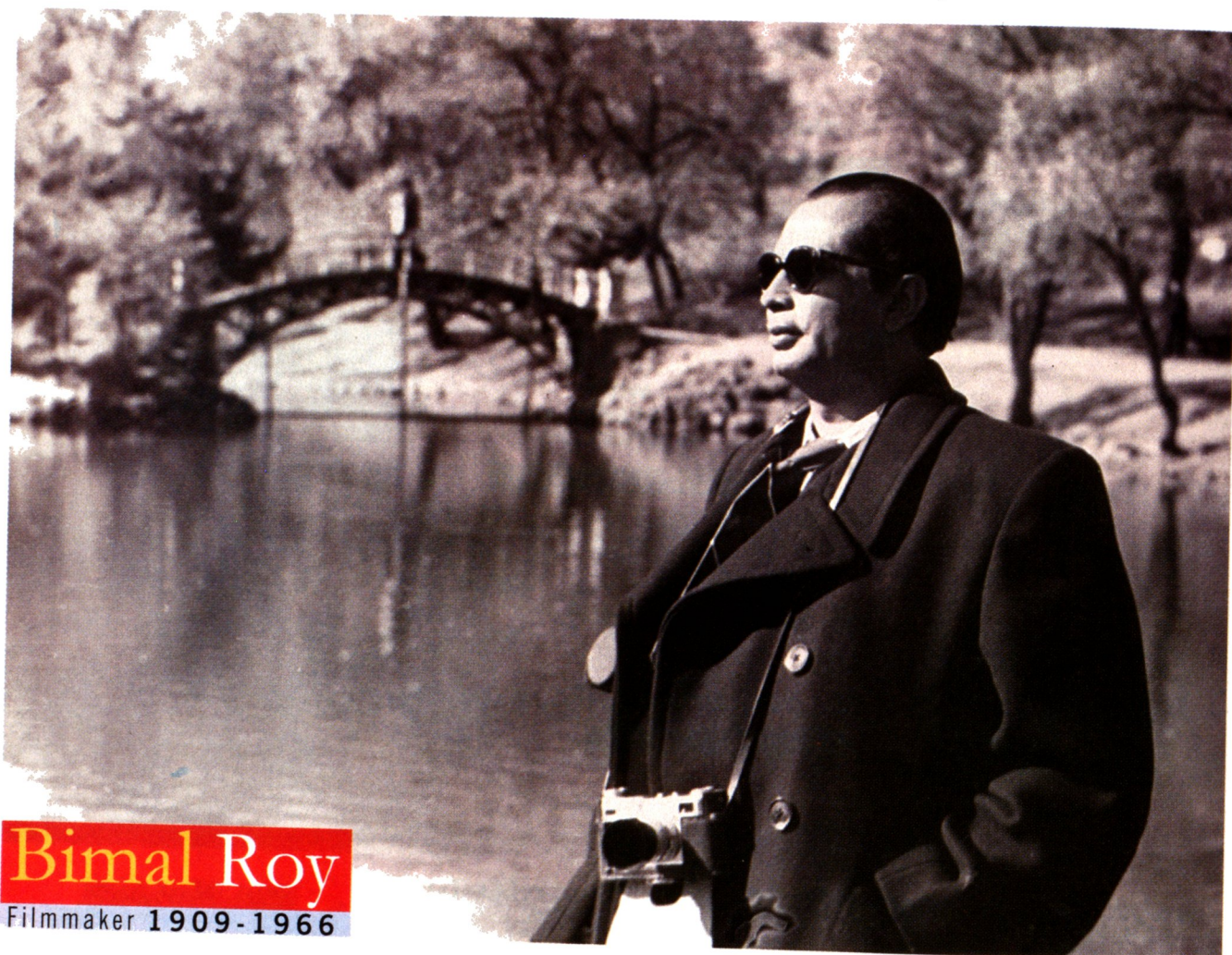


"Cinema is the most important means to help man understand his responsibilities and potential."



**Bimal Roy**

Filmmaker 1909-1966

# ROMANTIC REALIST

His attention to detail, almost rigid adherence to the narrative and the universality of human emotion that he so evocatively captured make him a filmmaker who has outlived his era

■ **By Joy Roy**

I remember as a young child being in rooms full of books and films. My two siblings and I would keep devouring the written word and imbibing images of the world. Often my father would invite guests and my mother would go into a frenzy over preparations for dinner. Not surprisingly, she was famed for her Bengali dishes. Fuelled by her cooking there would be long sessions

of engaging discussions at home.

There was a certain cultural ferment at home. Strangely Bimal Roy, the man, was unlike what people expected him to be. We were never encouraged to be in filmmaking. It was a passion for my father and perhaps incomprehensible to him that his own sons and daughters would want a future in it. More than cinema it was culture as a whole that existed at home.

I remember, after a trip to Beirut,

Lebanon, he got home a music player and some records. As a child I was astounded with the magic of music. I used to request him to put on the gramophone and would sit quietly with him. Seeing this, he would let me listen to it and would often introduce me to new records. He was always like that. Wherever he saw zeal he would encourage it.

The legacy of my father has been a power to me that has pushed me to explore his work as I was very young